

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation

Annual General Meeting

September 2021

Chair's Report



This is the 2nd Annual Report for the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation.

Genesis

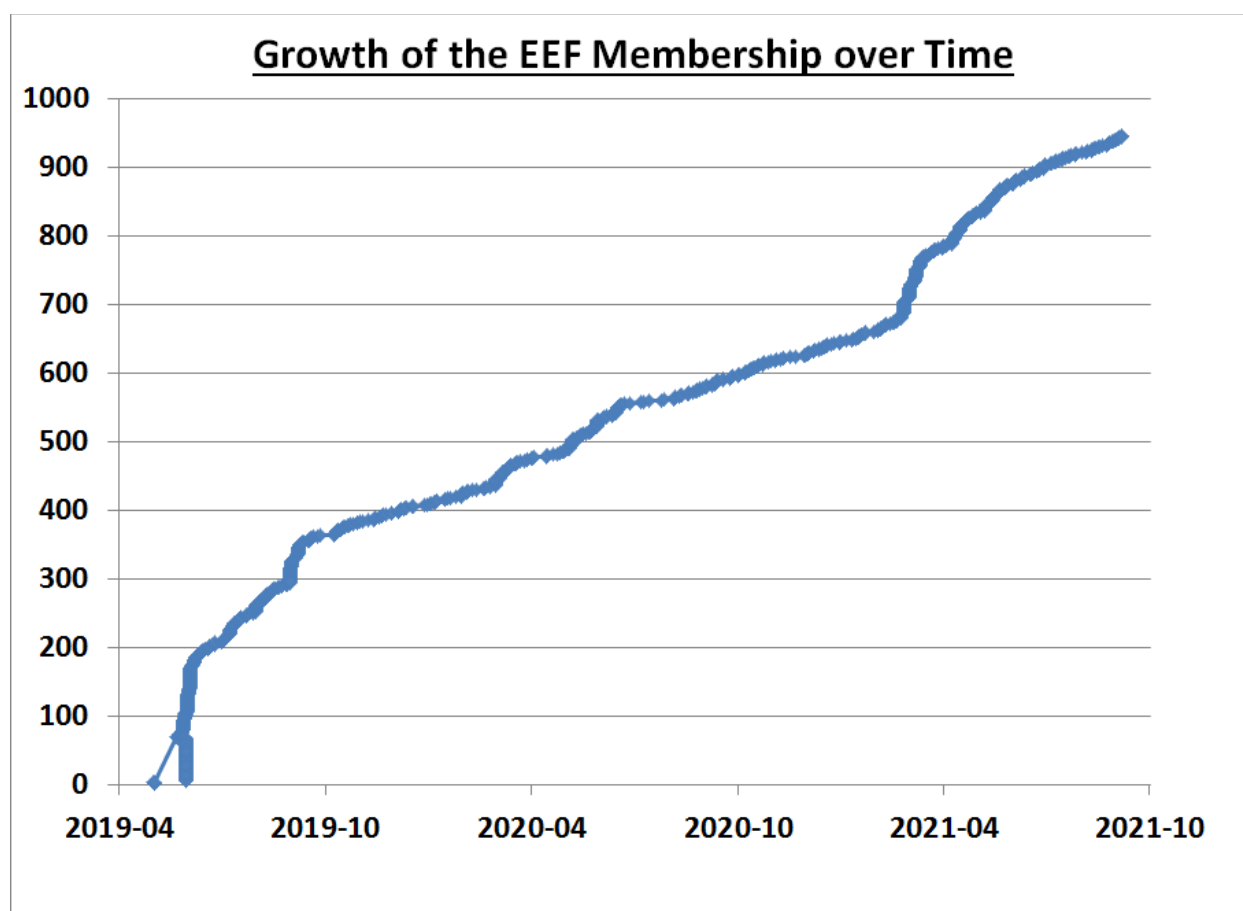
The Foundation officially filed its articles of incorporation as a California Nonprofit Public Benefit Corporation on Jan 19th, 2019 and it was duly registered as such on Jan 23rd, 2019. As of May 29th, 2020 we also received formal approval from the IRS as a US 501(c)(3) not-for-profit under federal tax laws.

Our Members

Per our charter and bylaws, we are a community benefit organization open to all persons interested in the well-being of the BEAM languages and the developers using them.

Summary	Keyword search	Advanced search	Saved searches						
Level	Total	Active	Renewal overdue	Lapsed	Pending			New in last	
					New	Renewal	Level change	7 days	30 days
Annual Supporting Membership	136	135	12	-	1	-	-	1	1
Basic Membership	767	767	-	-	-	-	-	6	22
Board	7	7	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Fellow	2	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Lifetime Supporting Membership	14	14	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Managing and Contributing	20	20	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total	946	945	12	-	1	-	-	7	23

As of the time of this report we have 946 members. This is an increase of 362 members or a 62% growth over the last 12 months. In spite of Covid and the ensuing lack of face-to -face interactions, the community has still been capable of expanding (see graph below)..



Membership covers 77 countries up from 64 countries 12 months ago. The table below shows the ranking of membership numbers per country.

Order	Country
1	United States
2	Brazil
3	Germany
4	India
5	United Kingdom
6	Sweden
7	Canada
8	Japan
9	Poland
10	Argentina
11	Italy
12	Spain
13	China
14	Netherlands
15	France
16	Russian Federation
17	Switzerland
18	Australia
19	Mexico
20	Portugal

Unsurprisingly, the distribution of countries reflects population size, density of software engineers and the historic centers of Erlang's adoption around the Baltic Region and Elixir's start in South America. There is also a 'long tail' of 18 countries with only one member. This observation applies to Albania; Angola; Bulgaria; Chile; Cuba; Czech Republic; El Salvador; Fiji; Honduras; Iceland; Luxembourg; Macedonia; Montenegro; Puerto Rico; Serbia; Slovakia; Vietnam and Zimbabwe.

In regards to expanding the membership, we will continue to focus on outreach and inclusivity. Several of our working groups, especially the Marketing and Education, Training & Adoption WGs have charters and have allocated budgets to promote diversity. Members with an interest in helping with diversity are encouraged to reach out to these two working groups.

Our Sponsors

We are grateful to our sponsors for their financial support. They are instrumental in putting the Foundation on a sound financial footing and allow us to invest in community development and future growth.

2020 was a slow year for fundraising due to Covid. Based on feedback from several of our sponsors we delayed the fundraising process based on feedback in early 2020 that companies would be cautious and we only really picked up the fundraising baton at the beginning of 2021.



The Sponsorship WG continues its focus on increasing our outreach to companies and other not-for-profits in the software development space.

Members working for companies who are heavy users of Elixir and Erlang are encouraged to broker relationships with their executives and the Sponsorship WG. We are interested in creating a virtuous circle of mutual interest and increasing the rate of the community's expansion. The number one feedback from our sponsors is for the EEF to help increase the available pool of BEAM developers.

The Working Groups

At the moment, there are still 12 chartered Working Groups within the EEF:

- Marketing
- Security
- Build and Packaging
- Fellowship
- Sponsorship
- Observability
- Education, Training & Adoption
- Embedded Systems
- Infrastructure
- Language Interoperability
- External Process Communication, Interoperability & Robustness (EPC)
- Machine Learning

In February, 2021 the board approved the proposal from the two working groups to combine the Documentation WG into the Build and Packaging WG. At the beginning of March, 2021 José Valim proposed a new working group, the Machine Learning WG which was also approved by the board, thus bringing us back to 12 working groups in total.

The board continues to be open to the chartering of new WGs from members who are passionate about a specific area and are willing to self-organize. The existing WGs are also interested in more active members joining them.

The Board

The board has held 54 meetings since the founding meeting on Thursday Feb 21, 2019. In March 2021 we held our Cohort B reelection process which led to two new board members being elected. The board would like to warmly thank the departing board members, Benoît Chesneau and José Valim, for their time serving on the board and we appreciate the work that they are continuing to do leading their respective working groups.

The following are the major regulatory compliance milestones in 2021:

- 2021-05-14; IRS Extension Form 8868 filed (2020 tax reporting)

Pursuant to the EEF Bylaws the following major actions were taken:

- 2021-03 Board elections by the voting members for cohort B per Section 5.5 & 14.8
(Sophie DeBenedetto, Maxim Fedorov, Bryan Paxton, Mirian Pena, Peer Stritzinger were duly elected)
- 2021-04 President & Secretary/Treasurer elections by the board per Section 5.5.1 & 14.8
(Sebastian Strollo (Secretary/Treasurer) and Alistair Woodman (President) were duly re-elected)
- 2021-08 The remote 2nd AGM was scheduled for 2020-09-09/10 per Section 3.12 & 14.8

In the last 12 months, the board also approved grants and stipends requested by various WGs for following areas:

Community Outreach (\$14,200)

Students to attend Code BEAM V	Sept 2020
Code Beam stipend for students and underrepresented	Feb 2021
SpawnFest sponsorship	Apr 2021
Education WG to sponsor student tickets for conferences	July 2021

BEAM Development (\$45,500)

Development of the Ryu algo for floating point formatting	Dec 2020
Development of JIT support for ARM64 & ARM32	Dec 2020
Porting the BEAM to the ROS, Robot Operating System	Mar 2021
Implementing float_to_* BIFs using the Ryu algorithm	Apr 2021
Further development of the PromEx library	June 2021

Starting in February, the board also approved an ongoing budget for an external marcom agency. The entity, Nayra, is based in Argentina and has been providing marketing communications services to the Marketing and Sponsorship WGs as well as the board.

Funding has also been provided to the Infrastructure and Marketing WGs to improve the general IT infrastructure and build out the **erlef.org** website. The following features are the result of these investments

- Basic working group management tools
- Working Group report support
 - Backed by git, we'll be utilizing this abstraction for other forthcoming features
- Erlef.org email for members program
- Slack invite support for erlef, erlanger, and lfe slack
- Basic calendar integration
- Conference perk program for members
- Misc. additions and improvements
 - Security audit and improvements
 - Community page
 - Public records page
 - Fellows gallery
 - Public site analytics
 - Internal error logging and alerts
 - Object storage support for media uploads
 - General UI/UX improvements
- (in development) Online blog support for the erlef.org website
- (in development) Discourse for members

The President and Secretary/Treasurer are recommending that the voting members ratify the actions of the Board and Officers of the EEF as being in the interests of the EEF and in accordance with the Bylaws.

Looking Forward

The board is looking at several avenues for activities over the next 6-to-12 months.

1) Jobs Board

Place for posting of job offers and job interests for members and sponsors

2) Open source repository / caretaker:

There are several conversations going on with respect to adopting open source projects that are in need of maintenance or where an entity wishes to transfer responsibility for projects to the EEF.

3) How to get more involvement:

We recognize that participation is especially difficult due to Covid-19 and we are evaluating options. Feedback and suggestions from the members in this regard are welcome, especially if we can get insight about regional or country specific opportunities.

4) More directed funding:

The board is asking the WGs to prioritize projects that they feel that the EEF should be supporting

5) Spending money:

Again due to Covid-19, most WGs are behind on their budget allocations. We intend to encourage more WG activity.

Best Regards

Alistair Woodman

Chair and President of the EEF